

documents, graphics or photo files are. Guess what—they are large enough to fill someone's e-mail box and cause their other mail to bounce! Get in the habit of compressing anything over 200,000 bytes. (You can view file sizes in Windows Explorer. Simply right-click on the file name and choose 'Properties'.)

There are several types of file compression software available for these purposes. Do not send unannounced, large attachments to others because you think that photo or file is cute or cool. Ask first! More importantly, when sending business files, do so only during business hours—and always compress and ask permission first!

Many onliners still have to wait up to 30 minutes or more to open overly large files due to their connection speed. Most of those online do not have cable or DSL connections, they are on dial-up—many only @ 28.8 Kbps!

Another way of reducing the size of your attachments is to manipulate them using graphics software. Minimising a photo or graphic's physical size to no larger than 600 pixels in width will make them e-mailable—nothing need be larger than that size to view anyway. Or you could be really courteous and learn how to use the free Web space offered by your ISP to upload photos, and simply send the link to friends and family to view. And if you do not know how to do any of these things, all you have to do is learn!

Tip

It should go without saying that sending e-mail with extremely foul, threatening or abusive language is crude. This includes obscenities, verbal harassment, threats of slander or personal comments that would prove offensive based on race, religion, or sexual orientation. Unfortunately, we see this type of behaviour all too often.